“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 12

How Jagadānanda Broke the Pitcher of Oil

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 O devotees, hear, hear constantly the nectar of Śrī Caitanya’s deeds; sing, sing it with joy; meditate, meditate on it.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to the merciful Lord! Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to the ocean of mercy!

3 Glory to Advaitacandra, the ocean of compassion! Glory to the devotees of Gaura, whose hearts are full of mercy!

4 After this Mahāprabhu was dejected at heart, and the state of separation from Kṛṣṇa constantly flashed forth in Him.[2]

5 “Alas, alas, Kṛṣṇa, Lord of My life, son of the king of Vraja! Where shall I go? Where shall I find You, O You whose lips hold the flute?”

6 Night and day He was in this state, and there was no peace in His mind. With difficulty He passed the nights in the company of Svarūpa and Rāmānanda.

7 Meanwhile in the land of Gauḍa all the Lord’s devotees set out to see Him.

8 Śivānanda Sena, Advaita Ācārya and all the devotees gathered in one place, in Navadvīpa.

9 The residents of Kulīnagrāma and all the residents of Khaṇḍa came to Navadvīpa, and all met there together.

10 Although Nityānanda Prabhu did not have the Lord's permission, He still set out to see Caitanya Gosāñi.

11 Śrīvāsa and his brothers, four in all, went with Mālinī, and Ācāryaratna's wife went with him.

12 Śivānanda's wife went, taking her three sons, and Rāghava Paṇḍita went with his bags (jhāli) packed.

13 Vāsudeva Datta, Murāri Gupta, Vidyānidhi and all the others set out, two or three hundred devotees in all.

14 They all went to see Śacīmātā and, taking her permission, set out joyfully, chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa.

15 Śivānanda Sena settled the tolls at the crossings; taking care of everyone, he led them happily along.[3]

16 He attended to everyone's needs and found them places to stay, for Śivānanda knew the roads through Orissa well.

17 One day all the people were detained at a toll post. Śivānanda had them all released and stayed behind alone.[4]

18 The others went on and waited under a tree in a village, for without Śivānanda no lodging could be found.

19 Nityānanda Prabhu, distressed by hunger and finding no lodging, began to berate Śivānanda:[5]

20 “May Śivānanda’s three sons die! He has still not come. I am dying of hunger, and he has not arranged any lodging for Me!”

21 Hearing this, Śivānanda’s wife began to weep. Just then Śivānanda came back from the toll post.

22 Weeping, Śivānanda’s wife said to him, “Finding no lodging, Gosāñi has laid a curse on our sons.”

23 He said, “Crazy woman, why weep yourself to death? Let my three sons die, taking His misfortunes upon themselves!”[6]

24 Saying this, Śivānanda went to Nityānanda Prabhu, and the Lord rose and kicked him.

25 Receiving the blow of His foot, Śivānanda was delighted. He quickly went to the house of a cowherd (*goyālā*) and arranged lodging there.[7]

26 Holding the Lord’s feet, he took Him to the lodging. Having given Him a place to stay, he spoke in delight:

27 “Today You have accepted me as Your servant and given me the punishment my offence deserved.

28 In the guise of punishment You show mercy — such is Your compassion. Who in the three worlds can understand Your ways?[8]

29 The dust of Your holy feet is rare even for Brahmā, yet my lowly body has received the touch of such feet.

30 Today my birth, my family and my deeds have become successful. Today I have obtained devotion to Kṛṣṇa, as well as wealth, pleasure and dharma."

31 Hearing this, Nityānanda Prabhu was delighted at heart. He rose and embraced Śivānanda with love.

32 Delighted, Śivānanda made the arrangements and gave lodgings to Advaita Ācārya and the other Vaiṣṇavas.

33 All of Nityānanda Prabhu's ways are paradoxical: when He becomes angry and kicks someone, He does that person good.[9]

34 Śivānanda's nephew was named Śrīkānta Sena. Hurt and indignant, he spoke when his uncle was out of hearing:

35 "My uncle is known as an associate of Caitanya, yet Gosāñi lords it over him and kicks him."

36 Saying this, the boy Śrīkānta hurried on ahead; leaving the party, he went to where Mahāprabhu was.

37 Still wearing his shirt (*peṭāṅgi*), he offered prostrate obeisances. Govinda said, "Śrīkānta, first take off your shirt."[10]

38 The Lord said, "Śrīkānta has come here with a sorrowful heart. Say nothing to him; let him do as he pleases."

39 The Lord asked for news of the Vaiṣṇavas, and Śrīkānta told Him about each of them by name.

40 Hearing the Lord say, "He has come here sorrowful," Śrīkānta concluded that the Lord is omniscient.

41 He did not tell the Lord that Nityānanda had kicked Śivānanda. Meanwhile all the Vaiṣṇavas arrived and met the Lord.

42 As before, the Lord met with everyone, and the women had His darśana from a distance.

43 As before, He had lodgings given to everyone, and He called them all to take mahā-prasāda.

44 Śivānanda introduced his three sons to the Lord, and for Śivānanda's sake the Lord showed great mercy to them all.

45 Seeing the youngest son, the Lord asked his name, and Śivānanda Sena told Him it was Paramānanda dāsa.

46–47 Earlier, when Śivānanda had come to the Lord, Mahāprabhu had said to him, "The son who will be born to you this time — name him Purīdāsa."

48 That son was then in his mother's womb. Śivānanda went home, and the child was born.

49 By the Lord's order they named him Paramānanda dāsa, and the Lord jokingly called him Purīdāsa.

50 When Śivānanda presented that child, Mahāprabhu placed His big toe in the boy's mouth.

51 Śivānanda's good fortune is an ocean — who can reach its farther shore? The Lord calls his whole family His own.

52 Then the Lord took His meal with all the devotees. After rinsing His mouth and hands, He gave Govinda an order:

53 “As long as Śivānanda’s wife and sons are here, they should receive the plate of My remnants.”

54 There was a confectioner (*modaka*), a resident of Nadīyā, named Parameśvara. He sold sweets, and his home was near the Lord’s house.[11]

55 In His childhood the Lord would go to his house again and again, and Parameśvara would give Him milk, sugar and sweets, which He ate.

56 He had loved the Lord ever since His childhood, and that year he came to see Him.

57 Saying, “I am Parameśvaryā,” he offered prostrate obeisances. Seeing him, the Lord spoke to him with affection:[12]

58 “Parameśvara, may you be well! It is good that you have come.” Then he told the Lord, “Mukunda’s mother has come.”[13]

59 Hearing the name of Mukunda’s mother, the Lord felt embarrassed, yet out of affection for him He said nothing.[14]

60 The boldness born of loving familiarity knows nothing of the niceties of courtesy. Within His heart the Lord was pleased with that quality of his.[15]

61 As before, the Lord cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple with everyone, and as before He danced in front of the chariot.

62 During the four months of Cāturmāsya they saw all the festivals, and Mālinī and the other ladies invited the Lord for meals.[16]

63 They had brought from home various foodstuffs dear to the Lord. Making vegetable dishes with them, they offered Him meals of home-

cooked rice.

64 By day the Lord enjoyed various pastimes with the devotees; at night He wept in separation from Kṛṣṇa.

65 In this way the four months of Cāturmāsya passed in various pastimes. Then the Lord ordered the devotees to return to the land of Gauḍa.

66 All the devotees invited Mahāprabhu for meals, and the Lord spoke sweet words to all of them:

67 "Every year you all come to see Me, and in coming and going you suffer hardships of many kinds.

68 Knowing your hardships, I want to forbid you to come. But in My heart the longing for the joy of your company keeps growing.

69 I ordered Nityānanda to remain in Gauḍa, yet He has broken My order and come. What can I say?

70 Ācārya Gosāñi has come here, showing Me mercy. I am bound by a debt of love that I can never repay.

71 For My sake they leave wife, sons and home, and come running over many difficult roads.

72 And I simply stay here, sitting in Nīlācala; I take no trouble for any of you.[17]

73 I am a sannyāsī; I have no wealth at all. With what shall I repay My debt to you?

74 My body is My only wealth, and I have offered it to you. Wherever you wish to sell Me, there I am sold."

75 Everyone's heart was gladdened by the Lord's words, and they all wept, tears streaming from their eyes.

76 The Lord wept with His arms around each one's neck; weeping and weeping, He embraced them all.

77 Everyone stayed on; no one could leave. Five or seven more days passed in this way.

78 Then Advaita and the Avadhūta Nityānanda spoke a few words at the Lord's feet: "By Your qualities alone the whole world is already sold to You.[18]

79 And now You bind us once more with such a rope of merciful words! Who could leave You and go anywhere?"

80 Then the Lord consoled them all and, composing Himself, bade everyone farewell.

81 To Nityānanda He said, "Do not come here again and again. You will have My company right there."

82 All the devotees set off weeping, and Mahāprabhu remained at home, sorrowful.

83 With the cords of His own mercy the Lord bound them all. Who could ever repay the debt of Mahāprabhu's kindness?[19]

84 The Lord is the supreme and independent Controller; He makes each one dance as He wills. And so people leave Him and go away to their own

lands.

85 He makes them dance as a conjurer makes a wooden puppet dance; the ways of the Lord cannot be understood at all.

86 The year before, Jagadānanda had gone at the Lord's bidding to the town of Nadīyā to see Āi, mother Śacī.

87 He went and paid homage at Āi's feet and presented her with Jagannātha's cloth and prasāda.

88 In the Lord's name he offered her obeisances and conveyed to her the Lord's humble words of praise.

89 Śacī rejoiced to have Jagadānanda with her. He spoke of the Lord, and she listened night and day.

90 Jagadānanda said, "Mother, some days the Lord comes here to you and eats.

91 After eating, He says joyfully, 'Today Mother fed Me till I was full to the throat.

92 I go there and eat, and Mother does not know it. I really do eat there, but she takes it for a dream.'"[20]

93 Mother Śacī said, "I cook so many fine dishes, longing in my heart for Nimāi to eat them here.

94 Then it seems to me that Nimāi has eaten them, but afterwards I think I must have been dreaming."

95 In this way Jagadānanda spent his days and nights with mother Śacī, telling her joyful news of Caitanya.

96 He met all the devotees of Nadīyā, and every one of them rejoiced to have Jagadānanda there.

97 Then Jagadānanda went to meet Advaita Ācārya, who was overjoyed to see him.

98 Vāsudeva and Murāri Gupta were delighted to have Jagadānanda; they kept him in their homes and would not let him go.

99 From his lips they heard the most intimate stories of Caitanya, and in the joy of those stories they all forgot themselves.

100 Whenever Jagadānanda visited a devotee's home, that devotee forgot himself in joy.

101 Blessed is Jagadānanda, the beloved of Caitanya! Whoever met him felt, "I have found Caitanya."

102 He went to stay in Śivānanda Sena's house, and there he prepared one measure of *candanādi* oil, sandalwood oil with other fragrant ingredients.[21]

103 He made the oil fragrant, filled a large pitcher with it and brought it carefully to Nīlācala.[22]

104 He left the oil with Govinda and told him, "Apply this oil to the Lord's body."

105 Then Govinda humbly informed the Lord, "Jagadānanda has brought some *candanādi* oil.

106 He wishes You to rub a little of it on Your head, to calm the flare-ups of illness caused by bile and air (*pitta* and *vāyu*).[23]

107 He prepared a pitcher of fragrant oil in Gauḍa and brought it here with great care.”[24]

108 The Lord said, “A sannyāsī has no right to use oil, and fragrant oil is a downright disgrace![25]

109 Give the oil to Jagannātha, so that it may burn in the lamps; then his labour will bear the highest fruit.”

110 Govinda gave Jagadānanda the message. The Paṇḍita kept silent and said nothing.[26]

111 When ten days had passed, Govinda informed the Lord once more: “The Paṇḍita wishes You would kindly accept the oil.”

112 Hearing this, the Lord spoke angrily: “Then why not keep a masseur to rub Me down?[27]

113 Was it for such pleasures that I took sannyāsa? What would be My utter ruin is a joke to all of you![28]

114 Anyone who passes Me on the road and catches the scent of oil will call Me a *dārī-sannyāsī*, a sannyāsī who keeps women.”[29]

115 Hearing the Lord’s words, Govinda fell silent. Next morning Jagadānanda came to the Lord.

116 The Lord said, “Paṇḍita, you have brought oil from Gauḍa, but I am a sannyāsī and cannot accept it.[30]

117 Take it and give it to Jagannātha, so that it may burn in the lamps; then all your labour will bear fruit.”

118 The Paṇḍita said, “Who tells You these lies? I never brought any oil from Gauḍa.”[31]

119 With these words he fetched the pitcher of oil from the room and smashed it in the courtyard before the Lord.

120 After breaking the pitcher he went straight home, bolted the door and lay down.

121 On the third day the Lord went to his door and called out, “Get up, Paṇḍita![32]

122 Today you must cook and serve Me My bhikṣā. I shall come at midday; now I am going to see Jagannātha.”

123 So saying, the Lord left, and the Paṇḍita got up, bathed and cooked various dishes.

124 Having finished His midday duties, the Lord came to eat. He washed His feet and took His seat.[33]

125 On a banana leaf the Paṇḍita heaped fine *śāli* rice with ghee, and all around it he set banana-leaf cups filled with dishes.

126 On the rice and dishes he placed tulasī blossoms, and before the Lord he set Jagannātha’s cakes and sweet drinks.[34]

127 The Lord said, “Serve rice and dishes on a second leaf. Today you and I shall eat together.”

128 The Lord sat with His hand raised and did not eat. Then the Paṇḍita spoke lovingly:

129 “Please take the prasāda Yourself first; I shall take it afterwards. How could I go against Your wish?”

130 Then Mahāprabhu happily began His meal, and as He tasted the dishes, He said:

131 “Even food cooked in a fit of anger tastes like this! By this I know that Kṛṣṇa’s grace is upon you.

132 Kṛṣṇa Himself is going to eat it, and so through your hands He cooks it so excellently.

133 You offer such nectarean food to Kṛṣṇa! Who can describe the limits of your good fortune?”

134 “The One who is going to eat is the cook Himself,” said the Paṇḍita. “People like me only gather the ingredients.”

135 Again and again the Paṇḍita served various dishes. Fearing to upset him, the Lord said nothing and ate with delight.

136 The Paṇḍita pressed Him to eat, and that day the Lord ate ten times as much as usual.

137 Time and again the Lord thought of rising, and at that very moment the Paṇḍita would serve Him more.

138 The Lord could say nothing and ate on, afraid that if He did not, Jagadānanda would fast.

139 At last the Lord said humbly and respectfully, “You have fed Me ten times as much as usual; now please stop.”[35]

140 Then Mahāprabhu rose and rinsed His mouth and hands, and the Paṇḍita brought spices to freshen His mouth, a garland and sandalwood paste.

141 The Lord accepted the sandalwood paste and the rest and sat down right there. “Today you must eat in front of Me,” He said.

142 “Let my Lord go and rest,” said the Paṇḍita. “I shall take prasāda as soon as I have finished here.

143 Rāmāi and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa have done the work in the kitchen, and I want to give them all some rice and dishes.”[36]

144 The Lord said, “Govinda, you stay right here. When the Paṇḍita has eaten, come and tell Me.”

145 Saying this, Mahāprabhu left, and the Paṇḍita turned to Govinda:

146 “Go quickly and massage the Lord’s feet, and tell Him that the Paṇḍita has now sat down to eat.

147 I shall keep the Lord’s remnants for you; when He has fallen asleep, come and eat them.”

148 He shared out the Lord’s rice and dishes among Rāmāi, Nandāi, Govinda and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa.

149 He himself ate what remained of the Lord’s meal. Then the Lord sent Govinda once more:

150 “See whether Jagadānanda is taking prasāda or not, and come quickly and tell Me the news.”

151 Govinda came and saw, and told the Lord that the Paṇḍita was eating. Only then did Mahāprabhu lie down at ease.

152 Such is the love between Jagadānanda and the Lord — like the love of Satyabhāmā and Kṛṣṇa of which we hear in the *Bhāgavata*.[37]

153 Who can tell the limits of Jagadānanda’s good fortune? In good fortune Jagadānanda has no equal but himself.

154 Whoever hears Jagadānanda’s *Prema-vivarta* knows the true nature of love and attains the wealth of love.[38]

155 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Caitanya-caritāmṛtam*, “the nectar of Caitanya’s deeds,” is also the title of the book. *Anubhāṣya*: hear, sing and remember it again and again. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: always hear this *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, sing it and joyfully meditate on it. ↩
2. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (p. 994) reads *mahāprabhu*; another reading is *mahāprabhura*, “Mahāprabhu’s heart.” The sense is the same. ↩
3. As in Madhya 16.19. *Anubhāṣya*: when pilgrims passed through a landlord’s estate they had to pay a toll, which went to the owners of the roads and crossings; at every toll post (*ghāṭī*) Śivānanda paid the toll due from the pilgrims to Jagannātha. ↩
4. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *ghāṭite*, “at the toll post”; another reading is *ghāṭiyāle*, “by the toll collector.” *Anubhāṣya*: the toll collectors oppressed the pilgrims and held them at the toll post to extort more than was due; Śivānanda stood surety for them all and had them released. ↩

5. Heading in the edition: Nityānanda, in His transcendental form as a cowherd boy of Vraja, has not satisfied His hunger and shows Śivānanda a feigned semblance of anger (cf. verse 33). ↩
6. *Tāṅra bālāi laña*, “taking His misfortunes upon themselves”: an expression of loving devotion, wishing that every ill that threatens the beloved may fall upon oneself. *Anubhāṣya*: *bāuli* means “crazy woman”; another reading is *bāunī*, “brāhmaṇa lady,” a respectful way of addressing women in those days. ↩
7. Heading in the edition (to verse 24): Śivānanda is blessed with the blow of Nityānanda’s foot. *Anubhāṣya*: *gauḍa-ghare*, “in the house of a cowherd (*goyālā*).” ↩
8. Heading in the edition: punishment or suffering sent by the Lord is a hidden, supreme mercy and happiness. ↩
9. *Viparīta* (in quotation marks in the text): “the reverse,” contrary to what one would expect. Heading in the edition: the semblance of anger in Nityānanda, the guru, is a hidden, supreme mercy and the sign of eternal good. ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *peṭāṅgi* — a shirt or coat. Heading in the edition: Govinda instructs Śrīkānta in the rules of respect before the Lord’s form. The *Anubhāṣya* quotes the tantras: one who bows down to Hari with his body covered by cloth is a fool. ↩
11. Heading in the edition: the story of Parameśvara the confectioner (*modaka*), a resident of Śrī Māyāpura. ↩
12. *Parameśvaryā*: the homely form in which the simple confectioner speaks his own name. Heading in the edition: Parameśvara introduces himself, bows down and announces that his wife has come. ↩
13. Mukunda’s mother is Parameśvara’s wife (see the heading to verse 57). ↩
14. Heading in the edition: the Lord, the guru of the world and teacher of mankind, who enacted the pastime of sannyāsa, feels embarrassed on hearing a woman’s name, even though she is elderly and like a mother to Him. ↩
15. *Praśraya-prāgalbhya* — “the boldness of loving familiarity”; *śuddha-vaidagdhī* — “pure courtesy.” The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *praśraya-prāgalbhya*; another reading is *praśraya-pāgala*, “simple in his affection.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to say to a sannyāsī, “Mukunda’s mother has come,” is the boldness born of long familiarity, and such boldness never knows the pure art of speech. *Anubhāṣya*: *praśraya* — affection, affectionate respect, humility, trust, loving liberty; *prāgalbhya* — boldness, forwardness; *vaidagdhī* — refinement, polish, skill, elegance of manners. Heading in the edition: the Lord, who accepts the feeling of the heart, is pleased with his guilelessness. ↩

16. Heading in the edition: after seeing the Lord's [Jagannātha's] festivals, Śrīvāsa's wife offers the Lord a meal. ↩
17. Heading in the edition: comparing it with the devotees' love for Him, the Lord humbly calls Himself devoid of love for them. ↩
18. *Vikāya*, "is sold," that is, won over — compare verse 74, where the Lord says that He Himself is "sold." Heading in the edition: Nityānanda and Advaita speak of the Lord's parental love (*vātsalya*) for His devotees. ↩
19. *Guṇa* means both "quality" and "cord." ↩
20. *Sākṣāte*, "in person, before her eyes." Heading in the edition: in the fullness of her motherly love Śacī takes for a dream the Lord's eating with her in person. The verse number is not printed in the edition. ↩
21. *Eka-mātrā*, "one measure"; *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: sixteen *sers* (about fifteen kilograms). Heading in the edition: Jagadānanda obtains sandalwood oil in Kāñcanapallī, comes to Purī and gives it to Govinda for the Lord. ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *gāgarī* — a pitcher (*kalasī*). ↩
23. Heading in the edition: Jagadānanda's unworldly, incomparable love for the Lord, whose human body is not of this world. ↩
24. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (p. 998) reads *gauḍe*; another reading is *gauḍete*. The sense is the same: "in Gauḍa." ↩
25. Heading in the edition: the Lord, guru of the world and teacher of mankind in the role of an ācārya, shows exemplary conduct. The *Anubhāṣya* quotes the *smṛti*: at the morning bath, during a vow, at a *śrāddha*, on Dvādaśī and during an eclipse, anointing with oil is like anointing with wine (some take "vow" to mean the vow of a renunciant); while for a householder, according to the *smārta* Raghunandana, anointing with ghee, mustard oil, flower-scented oil or boiled oil is not a fault. ↩
26. Heading in the edition: Govinda conveys the Lord's words to Jagadānanda; Jagadānanda's anger is the wounded pride of love (*praṇayābhimāna*). ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: a sannyāsī, a mendicant, has no helpers and must not accept the services of others; the Lord's words about a masseur are said in mockery. ↩
28. The verse number is not printed in the edition. ↩
29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: a *dārī-sannyāsī* is a sannyāsī who lives with a wife. *Anubhāṣya*: one who enjoys women — a fallen Tantric ascetic, hypocritical in conduct. ↩
30. Heading in the edition: although the Lord Himself is the enjoyer of all things, when Jagadānanda comes He, as the ācārya and teacher of mankind, shows the practitioner the example of renouncing sensual pleasure. ↩

31. Heading in the edition: the Paṇḍita, who loves the Lord, is angry with Him — this is the wounded pride of love. ↩
32. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Jagadānanda fasted for two days. Heading in the edition: Bhagavān, conquered by His devotee's love, dispels his hurt pride — that is, He begs for his favour. ↩
33. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *vasilā āsane*, "sat down on the seat"; another reading, *dilena āsane*, has Jagadānanda wash His feet and seat Him. ↩
34. *Piṭhā-pānā*: cakes and sweetened drinks (*pānā*). ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: *samādhāna* — completion, conclusion, end. ↩
36. The text says simply "Raghunātha." Heading in the edition: Rāmāi and Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, the Lord's servants and Govinda's companions, having cooked the meal, receive the Lord's prasāda. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: the love between the Paṇḍita, who wins Gaura over, and the Lord is like the love of Satyabhāmā and Vāsudeva in Dvārakā in the Dvāpara age. ↩
38. *Prema-vivarta*: the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* gives two meanings — the *vivarta* of love, that is, the behaviour in which, in the dealings of love, anger seems to appear; and the book *Prema-vivarta*, in which Jagadānanda wrote about Mahāprabhu's life. Heading in the edition: whoever hears the Paṇḍita's *Prema-vivarta* attains love for Gaura-Kṛṣṇa. ↩